

Torrent files on it. Apart from this, it will also prevent access to other popular torrent clients such as LimeWire, eDonkey, KaZaA, Bearshare, eMule, Morpheus, and many more.



Doing Nothing

With all the little cubicles and bays in today's office, it's almost impossible to make sure that everyone is working. Now there are a lot of employees who don't need to goof off in any of the various ways we've described above. Although rarer, this breed of employee is much more prone to goofing off, because you've spent all that money blocking things they never used in the first place. How can you make sure that a few employees are not sitting around reading the sports headlines, or curled up in that plush chair reading a book? Honestly, you may not even be able to tell if they're in their seats or not. Let's not even start thinking about what they're doing when you're out of office at a meeting or travelling abroad.



Monitoring / Spying Software

A keylogger or similar spying software can help track employee productivity. Such software can help you understand how each employee utilises time, and what they're doing in front of their PCs. For example, an employee who falls asleep will have the same screen in front of him for a long period. In such a scenario, a screen grabber spy software can show you that they haven't done anything for the past X number of hours / minutes.



Suggested Software

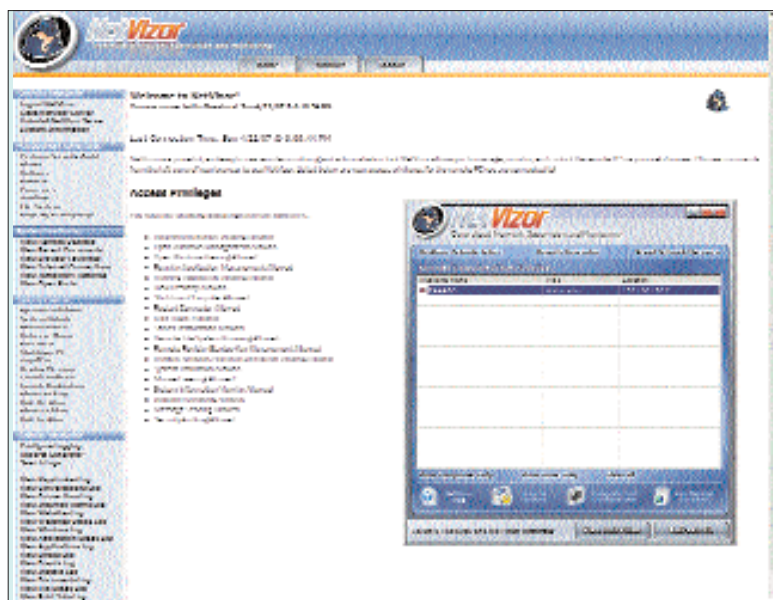
NetVisor (www.netvisor.net): The ultimate tool for any boss, NetVisor sounds almost too good to be true. This powerful software can tell you anything you need to know about PC usage of any employee in your company... seriously! The list of features is so long that we're going to have to give you a URL so you can see for yourself—www.netvisor.net/features.shtml.

We'll list the few that will excite you the most: per-PC logging of every keystroke typed, site visited, files opened, chat conversations, e-mail sent / received, applications run, software installed, and much more. It can also create reports and e-mail them to you, so even if you're out of office, you can check your mail and see who was doing what and for exactly how long. It can take snapshots of every desktop and upload it to a password-protected local or FTP server, or just mail each snap. You can view any computer's Desktop at any time over the network or the Internet. You can remotely run applications on any PC, look at what's stored on their hard drive, use End Task to kill any application you want, shut down / restart any computer, send messages to any computer screen, and freeze any mouse in the office (works great if someone's addicted to Minesweeper)! The software can be run in stealth mode to hide from all known anti-virus or anti-spyware solutions, and will not show up in Task Manager, the Registry, or even in startup. Of course, it also has the ability to show splash screens to users, warning them that they're being monitored—good to pre-

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vent lawsuits. It encrypts all its log files, manages disk space and processor usage to make sure the PC doesn't become sluggish, and is easily configurable by even a novice.

System admins will rejoice, because since it is basically an enterprise product, it can be deployed over the network from a single location, or over an entire domain. For all practical purposes, this software acts like a killer virus or worm, and puts every computer's reins in your hands. Before you start swooning in the drunkenness of your imagined power, you should consider the prices: \$295 (Rs 13,275) for up to five PCs, \$495 (Rs 22,275) for up to 10 PCs, \$1095 (Rs 49,275) for 51 to 100 PCs, etc., all the way up to \$4,995 (Rs 2,24,775) for over 500 PCs! We warned you, such solutions are never cheap! If you're a paranoid boss however, you may want the control this beauty of a software can offer you. Incidentally, NetVisor runs on Windows NT, 2000, XP and Vista.



Using software like NetVisor can give you detailed information on your employees

Take Heed

Warning: Depending on the laws of the land, the software solutions mentioned here might constitute breaking the law if not implemented correctly. For example, installing a keylogger or recording IM conversations could be construed as illegal by courts, and even be a violation of privacy. However, since it's the company's furniture and PC, it can dictate the way it is used. Usually, just being upfront about the solutions you deploy, and getting employees to sign a waiver or acknowledgement that they are aware of the methods you are employing to increase productivity and security, is enough. Still, if you're planning on using any of these solutions, get in touch with your legal counsel.

All this will obviously not make you very popular, but it will certainly sit well with your bosses. So go ahead, be evil, surrender yourself to the Dark Side, and start making your employees miserable! ■

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